

"AI uses so much energy, it's bad for the environment"

Posted by u/iwantxmax • • 0 points • 59 comments

Most of the energy used is from LLMs. Thats the most popular mode of Gen AI.

[A GPT 4o query uses about 0.3 watt hours.](https://epoch.ai/gradient-updates/how-much-energy-does-chatgpt-use?utm_source=chatgpt.com)

A midrange GPU used in modern consoles and most gaming PCS, pull 100-200 watts [(3060 for reference)] (<https://www.techpowerup.com/gpu-specs/geforce-rtx-3060-12-gb.c3682>) which they are constanstly going to be doing when playing most modern AAA games.

Therefore, if you were to prompt GPT 4o every minute for 8 hours straight, thats 480 queries, 480×0.3 watt hours = 0.144 kwh.

But gaming for 8 hours

$150 \text{ watts} \times 8 \text{ hours} = 1200 \text{ watt-hours} = 1.2 \text{ kilowatt-hours (kWh)}$.

And thats just the GPU, a PS5 consumes more, ~180W. And a low - mid range gaming PC does about ~400W, using AI is quite literally the better thing you can do for the environment than gaming. And by extension many other things you may do on a device. Like video editing, 3D animation, etc.

If AI didnt exist all that energy is still going exist, just allocated elsewhere, the world is still developing, growing and is always going to demand energy. And besides, there are always ways to power AI with renewable energy which is already done to some extent.

Comments

u/Dangerous_Cherry_471 • 1 points • 2025-10-27 03:55 UTC

The only thing y'all have proved here is that reddit is trash, which we didn't need further evidence of. The point is we need to use less, not more energy, and LLM based AI provides very few value adds, plus a ton of downsides I shouldn't need to get into. And actually, it's a big wake up call on how reckless other Internet activities are to us "antis" and we probably aren't gaming or on TikTok and never were because, brains. Streaming guilt has been around for a long time but we are encouraged to forget it.. We expected a faster uptake of renewable energy and that didn't happen and now we are in a climate crisis and need to change. Just because you suck at your job or whatever so much that something that is rarely correct actually improves your productivity, doesn't mean we need it.

u/Maleficent_Potato_16 • 2 points • 2025-09-17 21:21 UTC

I wanna say thank you for this. All i see is people saying how bad it is and its made me fear for the future and made me wanna avoid it when I know full well I cant. This post has actually helped me and my anxiety around it because I was so worried id be negatively contributing to the environment massively by using it to help me with uni (we love dyslexia) but seeing it all laid out like this (and not just this post other posts and my own research) have actually shown me that when I play the sims its no different and that actually weirdly helps ease the fear. Yes neither are good obviously but now I can use AI a few times without feeling like im a monster. (Im aware ive become the product of fear mongering how fun)

u/ArtisticLayer1972 • 1 points • 2025-05-08 00:04 UTC

Its not AI, its computers

u/TopHat-Twister • 1 points • 2025-05-06 07:54 UTC

<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-024-54271-x>

Here's another one

u/alexserthes • 1 points • 2025-05-04 20:59 UTC

[Individual vs. collective.](https://www2.deloitte.com/us/en/insights/industry/technology/technology-media-and-telecom-predictions/2025/genai-power-consumption-creates-need-for-more-sustainable-data-centers.html)

[Concern is mostly based off of projected use.](https://www.morganlewis.com/blogs/datacenterbytes/2025/02/artificial-intelligence-and-data-centers-predicted-to-drive-record-high-energy-demand#:~:text=THE%20FORECAST&text=As%20a%20result%2C%20analysts%20project,shifting%20reliance%20on%20generation%20resource

[Acting like this isn't considered notable is silly.](https://www.goldmansachs.com/insights/articles/AI-poised-to-drive-160-increase-in-power-demand)

[No, it's really not about just your consumption.](https://www.forbes.com/sites/bethkindig/2024/06/20/ai-power-consumption-rapidly-becoming-mission-critical/)

[Which is not to say that this is either unavoidable or that there are no noteworthy benefits which help offset the concern.](https://www.weforum.org/stories/2025/01/ai-energy-dilemma-challenges-opportunities-and-path-forward/)

[Without increased transparency, reworking current grids, and optimizing hardware though, it's most likely not sustainable.](https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-024-03408-z)

[So this is both a known and real problem, while also being, again, a very fixable problem. It hasn't been adequately addressed by the companies actually making AI though, and without greater accountability measures, I doubt it will be.](https://www.ll.mit.edu/news/ai-models-are-devouring-energy-tools-reduce-consumption-are-here-if-data-centers-will-adopt)

u/TawnyTeaTowel • 1 points • 2025-05-04 10:51 UTC

Humans use energy to make (for example) oil paint, which uses all kinds of dodgy chemicals, which they then load onto ships which use energy to move it around the world to shops, who use energy to power their websites to sell it to customers who use energy to use their PCs to buy it using their credit cards, the processors of which use energy to authorise the sale, then the shops package up the paint in boxes (which used energy to be produced) and hand them over to delivery companies who use energy to collect, sort and deliver the parcel to the customer, a trainee painter, who then uses that paint to produce some ghastly mess that even they wouldn't call art so it gets dumped in the trash to be collected and processed by the garbage company (using energy, of course) and it ends up sitting in landfill forever, leeching those dodgy chemicals into the soil.

That's much better, right?